

Data Profile Assignment

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1 PLATFORM RESEARCH AND DATA IDENTIFICATION

1.1 Selected Platform

Instagram

1.2 Types of Data Collected by the Platform

- A record of my activity including clicking, liking, commenting, and saving any advertisement, comment, post and stories.
- A copy of all the pictures that are being posted on my profile.
- A record of all interaction on the platform and messages.
- A record of all the current profile settings and preferences.

1.3 Selected Dataset

List of advertisers using my activity or information

1.4 Selected Dataset’s Original Size

4591

1.5 Selected Dataset’s Reduced Size

300

1.6 Categories

Number of categories identified: 10

- Fashion (e.g. H&M, Dr. Martens, UNIQLO USA)
- Fitness (e.g. Nike, Gymshark, Alphalete)
- Outdoors (e.g. Arc’teryx, The North Face, Burton Snowboards)
- Tech (e.g. Grammarly, Adobe, Sony Electronics)
- Travel (e.g. Airbnb, Expedia, Samsonite)
- Food (e.g. Panda Express, Kroger, Instacart)
- Health (e.g. iHerb, Sephora, Dermalogica)
- Entertainment (e.g. Hulu, Live Nation Concerts, Cinemark)
- Finance (e.g. Chase, Visa, Apartments.com)

- Other (e.g. Amazon.com, Etsy, IKEA)

1.7 Relevancy Data Buckets

- Relevant
- Somewhat Relevant
- Not Relevant

2 DATA ANALYSIS

2.1 Dataflow Sankeymatic.com Script

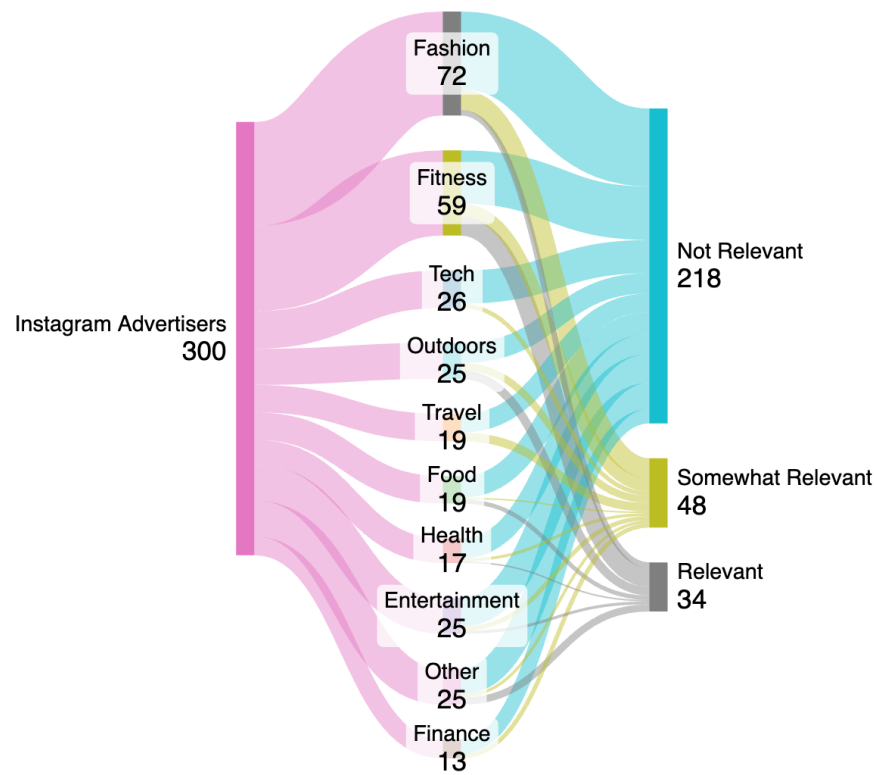
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Instagram Advertisers [72] Fashion
Instagram Advertisers [59] Fitness
Instagram Advertisers [25] Outdoors
Instagram Advertisers [26] Tech
Instagram Advertisers [19] Travel
Instagram Advertisers [19] Food
Instagram Advertisers [17] Health
Instagram Advertisers [25] Entertainment
Instagram Advertisers [13] Finance
Instagram Advertisers [25] Other
Fashion [4] Relevant
Fashion [14] Somewhat Relevant
Fashion [54] Not Relevant
Fitness [13] Relevant
Fitness [9] Somewhat Relevant
Fitness [37] Not Relevant
Outdoors [6] Relevant
Outdoors [5] Somewhat Relevant
Outdoors [14] Not Relevant
Tech [3] Somewhat Relevant
Tech [23] Not Relevant
Travel [6] Somewhat Relevant
Travel [13] Not Relevant
Food [3] Relevant
Food [1] Somewhat Relevant
Food [15] Not Relevant

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Health [1] Relevant
 Health [2] Somewhat Relevant
 Health [14] Not Relevant
 Entertainment [2] Relevant
 Entertainment [3] Somewhat Relevant
 Entertainment [20] Not Relevant
 Finance [3] Somewhat Relevant
 Finance [10] Not Relevant
 Other [5] Relevant
 Other [2] Somewhat Relevant
 Other [18] Not Relevant

2.1.1 Dataflow Diagram



Made at SankeyMATIC.com

Figure 1—Dataflow diagram

2.2 Table: Summary Statistics

Category	Relevant	Somewhat Relevant	Not Relevant	Total	Accuracy	Rubbish
Fashion	4	14	54	72	5.6%	75.0%
Fitness	13	9	37	59	22.0%	62.7%
Outdoors	6	5	14	25	24.0%	56.0%
Tech	0	3	23	26	0.0%	88.5%
Travel	0	6	13	19	0.0%	68.4%
Food	3	1	15	19	15.8%	78.9%
Health	1	2	14	17	5.9%	82.4%
Entertainment	2	3	20	25	8.0%	80.0%
Finance	0	3	10	13	0.0%	76.9%
Other	5	2	18	25	20.0%	72.0%
Total	34	48	218	300	11.3%	72.7%

2.3 Most Accurate and Most Rubbish Category

- Most accurate category: Outdoors
- Most rubbish category: Tech

2.4 Table: Regulated Domain Information

Regulated Domain	Number of Items	Advertiser Sample
Credit	8	Chase, BECU, Visa, Plaid, Afterpay USA, PayPal Honey, TaxRise, Triumph Capital
Housing	3	Opendoor, Apartments.com, Realtor.com
Employment	0	—
Education	4	University of Michigan, Study.com, Udemy, Osmosis from Elsevier

3 REFLECTION

3.1 Reflection – Amount of Data

I wasn't surprised when I found out Instagram collected all my information including activity, interaction, setting, etc since these are publicly available in the app UI as well if we know where to find them. What surprised me was the amount of data they kept, I was able to retrieve the data in 3 years before which

is how started with 4591 advertisers initially before trimming it down to 300.

3.2 Reflection – Accuracy of data

My Instagram data had mixed accuracy results. I would say most of the time they are spot on with the ads, for example, for outdoor category, they did recommended ads from my favourite companies such as ‘Salomon, Arcteryx, The north face, etc’ which contributed to the 24% accuracy, but they also introduced a lot of other outdoor brands that I wasn’t interested in or only interested at the time I clicked on the ads because a certain item grabbed my attention and I wanted to check it out and those are the ones contributed to 56% rubbish. Overall I think the data is pretty accurate in terms of which ads I clicked on, I wish they also track whether there is action followed after clicking on the ads such as whether user makes a purchase or signs up for newsletter or follow the advertiser’s Instagram page, etc to better identify which brands the users really like and only push ads for those brands.

3.3 Reflection – Changes made

As mentioned in 3.1 that Instagram stores big amount of our data date to few years back, while this is good that we are able to retrieve activity information in the past if necessary but after knowing how majority of the advertisers were not relevant, I plan to think twice before clicking on any ads, as well be more mindful with my action on social media platforms as every single of my activity and action is being tracked.

4 REFERENCES